KENNETH OTIENO ONDITI

Mammal Ecologist & Evolutionary Biologist

Kunming Institute of Zoology, Chinese Academy of Sciences · National Museums of Kenya
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RESEARCH PROFILE

Research focuses on the systematics, phylogeography and conservation biology of African mammals, with collaborative studies of mammals in China and Southeast Asia. Methods combine field-collected specimens with phylogenomic and morphometric analysis of species limits and diversification history, and macroecological analysis of how mammal diversity varies with elevation, ecoregion, climate and human pressure. Fieldwork is concentrated in Kenya, in joint surveys of the National Museums of Kenya and the Kunming Institute of Zoology (2015–2019).

41	10	418	12	13	76
PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES	FIRST/ CORRESPONDING-AUTHOR ARTICLES	CITATIONS	H-INDEX	I10-INDEX	PEER-REVIEW RECORDS

Citation figures: Google Scholar, 29 October 2026. Review records: ORCID, 31 October 2026. Articles: publication list below.

PROFESSIONAL APPOINTMENTS

Jul 2022 – Present

Special Research Assistant
Kunming Institute of Zoology, Chinese Academy of Sciences · Kunming, China

- Conduct research on the systematics, phylogeography and conservation biology of African mammals, and collaborate on studies of Chinese and Southeast Asian taxa.
- Analyse genomic and ecological data on species richness, phylogenetic and functional diversity and their associations with climatic and anthropogenic variables; study evolutionary history, taxonomy and morphological variation along elevational and ecoregional gradients.
- Served as principal investigator on NSFC grant 32350410430 (2024).
- Supervise graduate students in research design, data analysis and manuscript preparation.

Aug 2013 – Apr 2015

Research Assistant
National Museums of Kenya · Nairobi, Kenya

- Conducted field research on small mammals and their habitats, including habitat suitability analysis, survey-site selection and trapping design.
- Handled specimens in the field and laboratory and identified taxa from morphological and ecological characters.
- Contributed to monitoring protocols for mammals and habitats in Kenya; managed data digitisation and the reporting of project activities.

Apr – Aug 2012

Undergraduate Industrial Attachment
Nairobi City Water and Sewerage Company · Nairobi, Kenya

Environmental monitoring and compliance, wastewater quality assessment, and review of Environmental Impact Assessment and Occupational Safety and Health Audit reports.

EDUCATION

2018 – 2022

PhD in Zoology
University of Chinese Academy of Sciences · Beijing, China

Research at the Kunming Institute of Zoology, CAS, Kunming. Dissertation on the systematics, phylogeography and macroecology of African small mammals. Advisor: Prof. Jiang Xuelong.

2015 – 2018

Master of Natural Sciences
University of Chinese Academy of Sciences · Beijing, China

Research at the Kunming Institute of Zoology, CAS, Kunming. Advisor: Prof. Jiang Xuelong.

2009 – 2013 **BSc in Environmental Studies**
Kenyatta University · Nairobi, Kenya

FUNDING, FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

Research funding

Jan – Dec 2024 **National Natural Science Foundation of China (NSFC)**
Grant No. 32350410430 · ¥240,000 (approx. US$33,300) · Principal Investigator
Genomic analysis of the *Lophuromys flavopunctatus* species group: relevancy of conservation genomics to enhancing biodiversity management and human welfare.

2019 **IDEA WILD Grant**
Equipment for small mammal field surveys in Kenya.

Fellowships, scholarships and awards

2018 **CAS–TWAS President's Fellowship**
Full fellowship for PhD studies, 2018–2021. Chinese Academy of Sciences / The World Academy of Sciences.

2018 **Stipends for Junior Scientists**
Funding to attend the 92nd Annual Meeting of the German Society for Mammalian Biology, Bonn, Germany, including a visit to the Zoological Research Museum Alexander Koenig.

2017 **Council on Africa Award — Field Museum of Natural History**
Visit to the Field Museum of Natural History, Chicago, USA, for collaborative taxonomic work.

2015 **University of Chinese Academy of Sciences Full Scholarship**
Full scholarship for Master's studies, 2015–2018.

PUBLICATIONS

Author's name in bold. Reverse chronological, numbered from the earliest. Bibliographic details are taken from Crossref records and the author's reference library; titles are as published. Accepted articles that have no DOI yet are listed from the library alone.

Peer-reviewed journal articles (41)

41. Pei, X., Li, Y., **Onditi, K. O.**, Wang, H., Qin, W., Zhu, R., Li, Q., Song, W., Li, X., Zhu, Z., Chen, Z. & Jiang, X. (2027). Phylogeny and evolutionary history of the genus *Nectogale* (Soricidae) inferred from whole–genome analyses, with description of a new species endemic to the Himalayas. *Molecular Phylogenetics and Evolution*, 226, 108749. doi:10.1016/j.ympev.2026.108749

40. Chen, Z. Z., Shen, Y. C., Zhang, M., Pei, X. X., Xu, Y. F., Song, W. Y., Zhu, Z. X., **Onditi, K. O.** & Jiang, X. L. (2026). Systematic revision and species diversification of the genus *Episoriculus* (Mammalia: Eulipotyphla: Soricidae), with descriptions of two new species. *Zoological Research*. doi:10.24272/j.issn.2095-8137.2026.291

39. Diao, H., Xiong, Y., Nie, W., Pei, X., Song, W., Wang, X., **Onditi, K. O.**, Wang, H., Li, Q., Li, X., He, K., Chen, Z. & Jiang, X. (2026). Geographic isolation and climatic heterogeneity shape the genetic diversity of Blarinellini (Eulipotyphla: Soricidae) in the Hengduan Mountains. *Vertebrate Zoology*, 76, 611–624. doi:10.3897/vz.76.e188776

38. Hounmavo, A., Segniagbeto, G. H., **Onditi, K. O.**, Lutz, H. L., Delapré, A., Demos, T. C., Kerbis Peterhans, J. C. & Nicolas, V. (2026). Small terrestrial mammal inventory of Assoukoko forest (Togo), with new country records and potential new species for science. *Zoosystema*, 48(25), 741–781. doi:10.5252/zoosystema2026v48a25

37. Li, X., Hu, W., **Onditi, K. O.**, Hu, Z., Liu, Y., Wang, H. & Jiang, X. (2026). Beyond species richness: Habitat fragmentation reduces community occupancy and functional richness of mountain forest mammals. *Biological Conservation*, 318, 111828. doi:10.1016/j.biocon.2026.111828

36. Li, X., Hu, W., **Onditi, K. O.**, Li, Q., Hu, Z., Bai, R., Liu, Y., Wang, H. & Jiang, X. (2026). Functional homogenization of terrestrial mammals outside protected areas in the Hengduan Mountains, China. *Conservation Biology*, 40(3), e70214. doi:10.1111/cobi.70214

35. Li, Y., Xie, M., **Onditi, K. O.**, Li, X., Chen, G., Wang, H., Fang, Y., Shu, X. & Song, W. (2026). Rain-shadow effects drive contrasting elevational patterns and assembly processes of small mammal diversity on windward and leeward slopes. *Biodiversity and Conservation*, 35(8), 189. doi:10.1007/s10531-026-03383-z

34. Li, Y. X., Li, Q., Song, W. Y., Li, X. Y., **Onditi, K. O.**, Pei, X. X., Wang, H. J., Fu, C. K., Liu, S. Y., Chen, Z. Z. & Jiang, X. L. (2026). Integrative taxonomic revision of *Uropsilus* (Uropsilinae, Talpidae) combining genomic, morphological and geographic evidence. *Molecular Phylogenetics and Evolution*, 223, 108652. doi:10.1016/j.ympev.2026.108652

33. Li, Y. X., Chen, Z. Z., Li, Q., Zhang, T., Cheng, F., Song, W. Y., Li, X. Y., He, S. W., Wang, H. J., **Onditi, K. O.** & Jiang, X. L. (2026). Species diversification in the sky islands of southwestern China revealed by genomic, introgression, and demographic analyses of Asian shrew moles. *Systematic Biology*, 75(2), 221–235. doi:10.1093/sysbio/syaf052

32. Liu, Y., **Onditi, K. O.**, Hu, W., Jiang, X. & Li, X. (2026). Human pressures drive compositional homogenization and functional shifts in Southeast Asian mammal communities. *Global Change Biology*, 32(5), e70916. doi:10.1111/gcb.70916

31. **Onditi, K. O.**, Demos, T. C., Kerbis Peterhans, J. C., Nicolas, V., Mikula, O., Bryjová, A., Hounmavo, A., Monadjem, A. & Bryja, J. (2026). Diversification and biogeographic history of African dormice (genus *Graphiurus*) revealed by ultraconserved elements and mitochondrial data. *Molecular Phylogenetics and Evolution*, 217, 108549. doi:10.1016/j.ympev.2026.108549

30. Wang, X., Song, W., Xing, Y., Wang, Y., Pei, X., **Onditi, K. O.**, Wang, H., Li, Q., Li, X., Chen, Z. & Jiang, X. (2026). The Synergy Between Deterministic and Neutral Processes Drives Turnover-Dominated Beta Diversity of Non-Volant Small Mammals in the Western Tianshan Mountains, China. *Ecology and Evolution*, 16(11), e74538. doi:10.1002/ece3.74538

29. Bai, R., Ji, Y., Hu, W., Hu, Z., He, S., **Onditi, K. O.**, Wang, H., Xiong, Y., Zhang, J., Jiang, X. & Li, X. (2025). Seasonal differences and downstream transport of terrestrial vertebrate eDNA: Insights from integrated camera-trap survey and water eDNA metabarcoding. *Global Ecology and Conservation*, 62, e03854. doi:10.1016/j.gecco.2025.e03854

28. Hu, W., Li, X., **Onditi, K. O.**, Wang, H., Song, W., Hu, Z., Pu, C., Pu, M., Xiong, Y., Yang, S., Zhu, L., Yin, J., He, L., Song, H., Li, Y., Gao, G., Bleisch, W. V. & Jiang, X. (2025). Spatiotemporal distribution patterns of large and medium-sized mammals in a biodiversity hotspot: Implications for conservation. *Biological Conservation*, 301, 110863. doi:10.1016/j.biocon.2024.110863

27. Huang, C., Chen, Y., Li, L. L., Campos-Arceiz, A., Wang, Y., **Onditi, K. O.**, Li, Z., Feng, L., Liu, Y. & Lee, T. M. (2025). Human –wildlife coexistence needs more evidence-based interventions to reduce the losses of crops, livestock and fishery catches. *Journal of Applied Ecology*, 62(3), 527–544. doi:10.1111/1365-2664.14857

26. Koju, N. P., Anish, K. C., Dodhari, K., Giri, P., Lee, M., Pokhrel, S., Ghimire, A., Nyaichyai, L., **Onditi, K. O.**, Jiang, X. & Kyes, R. C. (2025). Spatiotemporal patterns and environmental determinants of wildlife-vehicle collisions in Banke National Park, Nepal. *Scientific Reports*, 15(1), 19478. doi:10.1038/s41598-025-04609-w

25. **Onditi, K. O.**, Song, W., Chen, Z., Li, X., Li, Q., de la Sancha, N. U., Musila, S. & Jiang, X. (2025). Multiscale spatial dependency of small mammal diversity patterns and their determinants. *Ecosphere*, 16(2), e70179. doi:10.1002/ecs2.70179

24. Sambaya, B. A., Ouru, S. M., He, S. W., Musila, S., Li, Q., Chen, Z. Z., Song, W. Y., Li, X. Y., **Onditi, K. O.** & Jiang, X. L. (2025). Integrative phylogeography of African striped grass mice (*Lemniscomys*): Cryptic diversity and habitat resilience. *Zoological Research: Diversity and Conservation*, 2(4), 233–249. doi:10.24272/j.issn.2097-3772.2025.030

23. Li, Q., Li, X. Y., Hu, W. Q., Song, W. Y., He, S. W., Wang, H. J., Hu, Z. C., Li, M. C., **Onditi, K. O.**, Chen, Z. Z., Pu, C. Z., Xiong, Y., Rao, C. H., Zhang, F. Y., Zuo, C. S. & Jiang, X. L. (2024). The mammals of Gaoligong Mountain in China: diversity, distribution, and conservation. *Zoological Research: Diversity and Conservation*, 1(1), 3–19. doi:10.24272/j.issn.2097-3772.2023.005

22. Mweu, A. W., **Onditi, K. O.**, Khanal, L., Musila, S., Kioko, E. & Jiang, X. (2024). Comparative phylogeography of two specialist rodents in forest fragments in Kenya. *Life*, 14(11), 1469. doi:10.3390/life14111469

21. **Onditi, K. O.**, de la Sancha, N. U., Musila, S., Kioko, E. & Jiang, X. (2024). Unravelling spatial scale effects on elevational diversity gradients: insights from montane small mammals in Kenya. *BMC Ecology and Evolution*, 24(1), 139. doi:10.1186/s12862-024-02328-w

20. Wang, S. Y., Li, Y. X., Li, Q., Song, W. Y., Wang, H. J., He, S. W., **Onditi, K. O.**, Khanal, L., Li, X. Y., Chen, Z. Z. & Jiang, X. L. (2024). A new species of mountain vole (Rodentia, Cricetidae, *Neodon*) from south Xizang, China. *Zoological Research: Diversity and Conservation*, 1(4), 282–289. doi:10.24272/j.issn.2097-3772.2024.011

19. Chen, Z., Pei, X., Song, J., Song, W., Shi, Z., **Onditi, K. O.**, Li, Q. & Jiang, X. (2023). Systematics and evolutionary history of the genus *Micromys* (Mammalia: Rodentia: Muridae). *Mammalian Biology*, 103(4), 389–403. doi:10.1007/s42991-023-00360-9

18. Chen, Z., Hu, J., He, K., Zhang, B., Zhang, Y., Chu, J., Zhao, K., **Onditi, K. O.** & Jiang, X. (2023). Molecular and morphological evidence support a new species of Asiatic short-tailed shrew (Eulipotyphla: Soricidae). *Journal of Mammalogy*, 104(6), 1455–1467. doi:10.1093/jmammal/gyad087

17. **Onditi, K. O.**, Song, W., Li, X., Musila, S., Chen, Z., Li, Q., Mathenge, J., Kioko, E. & Jiang, X. (2023). Untangling key abiotic predictors of terrestrial mammal diversity patterns across ecoregions and species groups in Kenya. *Ecological Indicators*, 154, 110595. doi:10.1016/j.ecolind.2023.110595

16. Oyebanji, O. O., **Onditi, K. O.**, Azevedo, J. A. R., Rahaingoson, F. R., Nneji, L. M., Adeleye, M. A., Stull, G. W., Zhang, R. & Yi, T. S. (2023). Biogeographic patterns and environmental drivers of species richness in the globally distributed Millettioid/Phaseoloid clade (Fabaceae, subfamily Papilionoideae). *Frontiers in Ecology and Evolution*, 11, 1231553. doi:10.3389/fevo.2023.1231553

15. Shi, Z., Yao, H., He, K., Bai, W., Zhou, J., Fan, J., Su, W., Nie, W., Yang, S., **Onditi, K. O.**, Jiang, X. & Chen, Z. (2023). A new species of forest hedgehog (*Mesechinus*, Erinaceidae, Eulipotyphla, Mammalia) from eastern China. *ZooKeys*, 1185, 143–161. doi:10.3897/zookeys.1185.111615

14. Song, W. Y., **Onditi, K. O.**, Li, X. Y., Chen, Z. Z., He, S. W., Li, Q. & Jiang, X. L. (2023). Decomposing niche components reveals simultaneous effects of opposite deterministic processes structuring alpine small mammal assembly. *Frontiers in Ecology and Evolution*, 10, 999573. doi:10.3389/fevo.2022.999573

13. Yu, Q., Hu, Z., Huang, C., Xu, T., **Onditi, K. O.**, Li, X. & Jiang, X. (2023). Suitable habitats shifting toward human-dominated landscapes of Asian elephants in China. *Biodiversity and Conservation*, 33(2), 685–704. doi:10.1007/s10531-023-02766-w

12. Chen, Z., Hu, T., Pei, X., Yang, G., Yong, F., Xu, Z., Qu, W., **Onditi, K. O.** & Zhang, B. (2022). A new species of Asiatic shrew of the genus *Chodsigoa* (Soricidae, Eulipotyphla, Mammalia) from the Dabie Mountains, Anhui Province, eastern China. *ZooKeys*, 1083, 129–146. doi:10.3897/zookeys.1083.78233

11. Hu, W., **Onditi, K. O.**, Jiang, X., Wu, H. & Chen, Z. (2022). Modeling the potential distribution of two species of shrews (*Chodsigoa hypsibia* and *Anourosorex squamipes*) under climate change in China. *Diversity*, 14(2), 87. doi:10.3390/d14020087

10. **Onditi, K. O.**, Song, W. Y., Li, X. Y., Chen, Z. Z., Li, Q., He, S. W., Musila, S., Kioko, E. & Jiang, X. L. (2022). Patterns and predictors of small mammal phylogenetic and functional diversity in contrasting elevational gradients in Kenya. *Frontiers in Ecology and Evolution*, 9, 742524. doi:10.3389/fevo.2021.742524

9. Pei, X., Ren, X., Hu, J., **Onditi, K. O.**, Xu, Y., Zhang, M., Chang, W. & Chen, Z. (2022). Human disturbance and geometric constraints drive small mammal diversity and community structure along an elevational gradient in eastern China. *Animals*, 12(15), 1915. doi:10.3390/ani12151915

8. Song, W. Y., Li, X. Y., **Onditi, K. O.** & Jiang, X. L. (2022). Methodological advances in explaining community assembly with niche-based theory. *Acta Theriologica Sinica*, 42(3), 312–324. doi:10.16829/j.slxb.150613

7. Chen, Z. Z., He, S. W., Hu, W. H., Song, W. Y., **Onditi, K. O.**, Li, X. Y. & Jiang, X. L. (2021). Morphology and phylogeny of scalopine moles (Eulipotyphla: Talpidae: Scalopini) from the eastern Himalayas, with descriptions of a new genus and species. *Zoological Journal of the Linnean Society*, 193(2), 432–444. doi:10.1093/zoolinnean/zlaa172

6. **Onditi, K. O.**, Li, X., Song, W., Li, Q., Musila, S., Mathenge, J., Kioko, E. & Jiang, X. (2021). The management effectiveness of protected areas in Kenya. *Biodiversity and Conservation*, 30(13), 3813–3836. doi:10.1007/s10531-021-02276-7

5. **Onditi, K. O.**, Demos, T. C., Kerbis Peterhans, J., Chen, Z. Z., Bryja, J., Lavrenchenko, L. A., Musila, S., Verheyen, E., Van de Perre, F., Akaibe, B. D., de la Sancha, N. U. & Jiang, X. L. (2021). Historical biogeography, systematics, and integrative taxonomy of the non-Ethiopian speckled pelage brush-furred rats (*Lophuromys flavopunctatus* group). *BMC Ecology and Evolution*, 21(1), 89. doi:10.1186/s12862-021-01813-w

4. Chen, Z., Li, X., Song, W., Li, Q., **Onditi, K. O.**, Khanal, L. & Jiang, X. (2020). Small mammal species richness and turnover along elevational gradient in Yulong Mountain, Yunnan, Southwest China. *Ecology and Evolution*, 10(5), 2545–2558. doi:10.1002/ece3.6083

3. **Onditi, K. O.**, Peterhans, J. K., Demos, T. C., Musila, S., Chen, Z. Z. & Jiang, X. L. (2020). Morphological and genetic characterization of Mount Kenya brush-furred rats (*Lophuromys* Peters 1874); relevance to taxonomy and ecology. *Mammal Research*, 65(2), 387–400. doi:10.1007/s13364-019-00470-1

2. Song, W. Y., Li, X. Y., Chen, Z. Z., Li, Q., **Onditi, K. O.**, He, S. W. & Jiang, X. L. (2020). Isolated alpine habitats reveal disparate ecological drivers of taxonomic and functional beta-diversity of small mammal assemblages. *Zoological Research*, 41(6), 670–683. doi:10.24272/j.issn.2095-8137.2020.085

1. Musila, S., Chen, Z. Z., Li, Q., Yego, R., Zhang, B., **Onditi, K. O.**, Muthoni, I., He, S. W., Omondi, S., Mathenge, J., Kioko, E. N. & Jiang, X. L. (2019). Diversity and distribution patterns of non-volant small mammals along different elevation gradients on Mt. Kenya, Kenya. *Zoological Research*, 40(1), 53–60. doi:10.24272/j.issn.2095-8137.2019.004

Preprints (2)

2. Hu, Z., Yu, Q., **Onditi, K. O.**, Zhu, C., Wang, H., Liu, Y., Li, X. & Jiang, X. (2026). The protection of Asian elephants in China caught in a conservation trap. *SSRN* (preprint). doi:10.2139/ssrn.7010506

1. Zhu, C., Hu, Z., Yang, M., Liu, Y., **Onditi, K. O.**, Wang, H., Jiang, X. & Li, X. (2026). Non-random defaunation across China's protected area network revealed by multidimensional dark diversity. *Research Square* (preprint). doi:10.21203/rs.3.rs-10531544/v1

PRESENTATIONS

Invited talks

7 Jul 2025 — **Community ecology of terrestrial mammals of Kenya: eco-evolutionary patterns and processes, and conservation implications**
University of Potsdam, Institute of Biochemistry and Biology · Potsdam, Germany

31 Oct 2024 — **The problem of spatial scale in small mammal diversity patterns and processes**
Masaryk University, Vertebrate Research Group, Faculty of Science · Brno, Czech Republic

Conference presentations

3–6 Jun 2024 — **Effectiveness of protected areas in Kenya based on terrestrial mammal diversity patterns: implications for conservation strategies**
Poster · 1st Joint International Scientific Conference, National Museums of Kenya · Nairobi, Kenya

27 Aug 2023 — **Untangling key abiotic predictors of terrestrial mammal diversity patterns in Kenya and the protected areas' management implications**
Oral presentation · 16th National Academic Symposium on Wildlife Ecology and Resource Conservation, Chinese Zoological Society · Yichang, Hubei, China

23 Nov 2018 — **Morphometrics of the *Lophuromys aquilus* species complex: taxonomic and biogeographic relevancy**
Oral presentation · 14th National Symposium on Wildlife Ecology and Resource Conservation, Chinese Zoological Society · Kunming, Yunnan, China

18 Sep 2018 — **Morphological variation, biogeography, and a taxonomic synopsis of the *Lophuromys aquilus* species complex**
Oral presentation · 92nd Annual Meeting of the German Society for Mammalian Biology, Museum Koenig · Bonn, Germany

FIELD RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

The five campaigns with specimen counts were joint surveys of the National Museums of Kenya (NMK) and the Kunming Institute of Zoology, CAS; together they yielded 5,974 catalogued small mammal specimens. Methods: Sherman live traps, snap traps, and pitfall –drift-fence arrays on standardised elevational transects; external and cranial measurements in the field; tissue sampling in 95% ethanol; voucher preparation and accession into the NMK mammal collection.

28 Sep – 14 Nov 2019 — **Cherang'any Hills, Mount Elgon and Mathews Range, Kenya**
854 specimens · rodents and shrews
Montane survey of three geographically isolated highlands, along elevational gradients in western and northern Kenya.

12 Aug – 14 Sep 2018 — **Mau Forests, Kakamega Forest and Yala Swamp, Kenya**
1,450 specimens · rodents and shrews
Gradient from highland forest through Guineo-Congolian lowland rainforest to wetland.

9 Jan – 5 Feb 2018 — **Loita Hills forest ecosystem, Kenya**
877 specimens · rodents and shrews
Dry montane forest isolated from other Kenyan highlands.

19 Aug – 22 Sep 2016 — **Chyulu Hills, Tsavo National Parks, Shimba Hills and Gongoni Forest, Kenya**
861 specimens · rodents, shrews and bats
East–west transect from coastal forest to interior savanna.

6 Sep – 13 Oct 2015 — **Mount Kenya (Chogoria and Sirimon transects), Kenya**
1,932 specimens · rodents and shrews
Two elevational transects, from montane forest through bamboo and moorland to alpine heath.

Jul – Aug 2015 — **Loita Forest and Kakamega Forest National Reserve, Kenya**
Forest-dependent small mammal communities in two contrasting forest types, with a team led by Prof. Julian Kerbis Peterhans (Field Museum of Natural History / Roosevelt University).

GRADUATE SUPERVISION & MENTORSHIP

MSc students at the Kunming Institute of Zoology, CAS.

2022 – 2025	**Brian Anoto Sambaya** Integrative phylogeography of African striped grass mice (*Lemniscomys*). First-author article: Sambaya et al. (2025), *Zoological Research: Diversity and Conservation*, 2(4), 233–249.
2019 – 2022	**Alois Wambua Mweu** Comparative phylogeography of specialist rodents in Kenyan forest fragments. First-author article: Mweu et al. (2024), *Life*, 14(11), 1469.
2019 – 2022	**Samson Mabeya Ouru**

PEER REVIEW & MEMBERSHIPS

Peer review	76 review records for 24 journals, 2020–2026 (ORCID, 31 October 2026). Sustainability (15); Ecology and Evolution (12); Animals (7); Land (6); Biology (4) Three each: Diversity and Distributions; Ecosphere; Global Change Biology; Global Ecology and Biogeography Two each: Birds; Diversity; Forests; Mammalian Biology; Wild One each: Biological Conservation; Conservation Science and Practice; Ecological Indicators; Geology Ecology and Landscapes; Journal of Applied Ecology; Journal of Biogeography; Journal of Threatened Taxa; Journal of Wildlife Management; Journal of Zoological Systematics & Evolutionary Research; Plant Ecology & Diversity
Societies	Association for Tropical Biology and Conservation; Ecological Society for Eastern Africa; Ecological Society of America; Society for the Study of Evolution; Society for Tropical Ecology (gtö); Society of Systematic Biologists.

SKILLS

Systematics & genomics	Integrative taxonomy; phylogenomics with ultraconserved elements (UCEs); mitochondrial and multilocus phylogenetics; species delimitation; divergence-time and demographic inference; linear and geometric morphometrics.
Macroecology & modelling	Species distribution and habitat suitability modelling; phylogenetic and functional diversity; beta-diversity decomposition; occupancy modelling; multiscale spatial analysis; protected-area effectiveness assessment.
Field & collections	Small mammal live-trapping, snap-trapping and pitfall arrays; elevational transect design; specimen preparation, curation and museum accession; tissue archiving.
Computing	R (statistical modelling, spatial analysis, reproducible workflows); bioinformatics pipelines for phylogenomic data; GIS.
Languages	English (fluent) · Swahili (fluent) · Mandarin Chinese (basic)

REFEREES

Prof. Jiang Xuelong · Principal Investigator
Kunming Institute of Zoology, Chinese Academy of Sciences · Kunming, China

Dr. Esther Kioko · Senior Research Scientist
National Museums of Kenya · Nairobi, Kenya

Dr. Julian Kerbis Peterhans · Curator
Field Museum of Natural History · Chicago, USA

Dr. Simon Musila · Senior Research Scientist & Head, Mammalogy Section
National Museums of Kenya · Nairobi, Kenya

Referee contact details are available on request.